Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Thursday, 29 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Overcast	Light drizzle	Overcast
17° 11°	15° 10°	15° 10°	14° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The Chancellor's latest Budget has been described as 'cautious' despite a range of smaller measures designed to help the country.**

It seems the government is grappling with a difficult mix of public and household finances. Political commentators are suggesting a careful approach was needed.

POLITICS · UK

2 **Thousands of patients across the UK are reportedly living in 'horrific pain' due to a widespread shortage of vital medication.**

One woman, Jill Kenning, says she's been unable to get a crucial drug for her condition. This highlights a serious problem affecting many people.

HEALTH · UK

3 **Bonfire Night policing in Scotland is set to be the biggest operation since Donald Trump's last visit, with huge numbers of officers on duty.**

Up to 1,700 officers could be deployed to manage fireworks-related disorder, a European football match, and potential protests in Glasgow. It sounds like a busy night for the emergency services.

PUBLIC SAFETY · UK

4 **Police in Northern Ireland are investigating an explosive device found at a hotel, with 'dissident republicans' thought to be responsible.**

The package was discovered on Tuesday afternoon at Ebrington Square in the Waterside area. This is a concerning development for the region.

CRIME · UK

5 **Police are facing criticism over delays in responding to a 999 mountain call after two young climbers tragically died.**

Jayden Long and Eddie Hill lost their lives after police reportedly failed to adequately escalate a dropped 999 call. An investigation is now underway.

PUBLIC SAFETY · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Jay-Z is set to headline the prestigious Super Bowl half-time show, a performance many have been waiting for!**

The rap mogul has been involved with the show for years behind the scenes, but this will be his first time taking to the stage himself. It's going to be a massive spectacle.

> ON AIR — Are you excited for Jay-Z to finally take the Super Bowl stage? What's your favourite Super Bowl half-time show ever?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **Singer Jamie Miller, who just hit number one with 'Babydoll', says his life will 'never be the same again' after the success.**

He's finding genuine joy in life again after a difficult period led to him quitting music. It's a fantastic comeback story for the star.

> ON AIR — Isn't it great to hear about an artist finding joy in their career again? What's your favourite comeback story in music?

MUSIC · NOW

3 **A mum has quit her job as a lawyer to pursue a new career voicing characters for Netflix cartoons!**

Emily McGonagle, 42, decided to make the career change after watching children's shows like Peppa Pig and Paw Patrol on repeat. Talk about a dream job!

> ON AIR — What a brave move! If you could quit your job and do anything, what would it be?

TV · NOW

4 **Fans of 'romantasy' books are rejoicing as a new release hits the shelves, with special 'lock-in' events celebrating the genre.**

About 40 fans of the 'A Court of Thorns and Roses' series celebrated at an event in Carrickfergus. It seems this fantasy romance genre is really taking off!

> ON AIR — Have you ever been to a book launch or a fan event for your favourite series? What's the last book you couldn't put down?

BOOKS · NOW

5 **Sam Fender's pre-sale tickets for his Newcastle shows have been moved after what he's called a 'sophisticated bot attack'.**

It seems a website selling tickets was targeted, causing issues for fans trying to get their hands on them. Hopefully, everyone will get a fair chance to see him live.

> ON AIR — Have you ever had trouble getting tickets for a gig because of bots or website issues? Who's the one artist you'd love to see live?

MUSIC · COMING UP

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **England captain Harry Kane has won the prestigious Ballon d'Or, explaining how his game has evolved to reach the top.**

It's a huge achievement for Kane, who also discussed his incredible goal-scoring form with Bayern this season. He's the first English player to win it since Michael Owen in 2001.

ON AIR — How big is this for English football? Do you think Harry Kane is one of our greatest ever players?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Manchester United striker Benjamin Sesko is expected to be out until at least January after suffering a shin injury.**

This is a blow for United, who will be without the key player for several weeks. He'll be hoping for a speedy recovery.

ON AIR — How much will Manchester United miss Sesko? Who do you think needs to step up in his absence?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Novak Djokovic has celebrated a 'big win' on his return to Basel, keeping his hopes alive for the ATP Finals.**

The tennis star pulled off a hard-fought comeback victory over Ugo Humbert. It was a crucial match for his season-ending ambitions.

ON AIR — Is Djokovic still the man to beat in men's tennis? Who are you backing for the ATP Finals?

TENNIS · GLOBAL

4 **Fleetwood Town pulled off a stunning Carabao Cup upset against Arsenal, in what's being called the 'biggest night in the club's history'.**

A whopping 83 league places separated the two sides, but Fleetwood booked their place in the quarter-final thanks to a penalty shootout win. What a story!

ON AIR — What a giant-killing! What's the biggest football upset you've ever seen or remember hearing about?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **The Red Roses have made six changes to their side to face the United States, with star Ellie Kildunne on the bench again.**

Head coach John Mitchell is rotating his squad, but it's a surprise to see Kildunne not starting. It will be interesting to see how the team performs.

ON AIR — Is it a good idea to rotate the squad so much, or should they stick with a winning formula? Are you looking forward to this match?

RUGBY · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **A survey finds most of us have a drawer, shelf or cupboard we're slightly afraid to open.**
The 'everything drawer' is a near-universal feature of British homes. Inside: takeaway menus, dead batteries and one very important thing we'll never find again.

2 **Loneliness is now considered a bigger health risk than smoking 15 cigarettes a day, according to NHS England.**
Social prescribing — GPs referring patients to community activities — is rolling out nationwide. Walking groups, book clubs and choirs are reportedly oversubscribed.

3 **A study suggests we underestimate how much our neighbours would like to be asked for help.**
Researchers say a small favour often builds friendships faster than years of polite nodding over the fence.

4 **The number of people learning to play an instrument as an adult is rising fast.**
Piano and guitar lead the way, with online lessons making it easier. The hardest part, learners say, is finding somewhere to practise without an audience.

5 **The fastest-growing hobby of 2026 is hand-embroidery — sales of needles and thread up 180% in a year.**
Crafters say it's the perfect 'phone detox' — slow, tactile, satisfying. TikTok is full of 20-somethings showing off custom denim jackets.

6 **Almost two thirds of us say we've cried at a podcast in the last year — grief, parenting and identity top the list of triggers.**
Researchers reckon it's the intimacy of audio that does it. The figure is even higher for under-30s, 71% of whom admit a recent podcast-induced tear.

7 **Roses are out, peonies are in — UK florists report a 200% rise in peony orders for weddings this summer.**
Brides cite 'softer, less staged' aesthetics. Wholesale peony prices have crept up accordingly.

Prepflow

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **71% of us admit to doing THIS in the car when we think no-one is watching. What is it?**

ANSWER: SINGING AT THE TOP OF OUR LUNGS, WITH FULL DRAMATIC FACIAL EXPRESSIONS.

Q **Asked 'what's the most British thing about your morning?', the number one answer wasn't a cup of tea — it was THIS.**

ANSWER: APOLOGISING TO SOMEONE WHO WALKED INTO YOU.

TALK TOPIC

- **A new poll says the most-missed shop from the high street is one a lot of us took for granted.**
  Which closed-down shop do you still think about — and what did you always buy there?

- **Most of us apparently have one recipe we've made so often we could do it blindfolded.**
  What's your signature dish — and where did you learn it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** The Great Fire of London in 1666 destroyed thousands of houses but, remarkably, the official death toll recorded only a handful of people.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A museum has discovered that a Tudor monarch kept a 'royal sneezer' — a courtier whose sole duty was to sneeze first so the king never had to be the one who started it.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Wall of China isn't actually visible from space without aid, despite the myth.
- There are more possible games of chess than atoms in the observable universe.
- A flock of crows is called a 'murder'.
- The unicorn is mentioned in the Bible nine times.
- Coca-Cola would be green if colouring wasn't added to it.
- A day on Venus is longer than a year on Venus.
- Polar bears have black skin under their white fur.
- Hot water freezes faster than cold water under certain conditions — it's called the Mpemba effect.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES THU 29 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 302 of the year, 63 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abraham of Rostov; Christian feast day: Blessed Chiara Badano; Christian feast day: Colman mac Duagh; Christian feast day: Douai Martyrs. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1965 — Michael Passons, American singer-songwriter
- 1984 — Chris Baio, American bass player
- 1949 — James Williamson, American guitarist, songwriter, and producer
- 1948 — Kate Jackson, American actress, director, and producer
- 1961 — Randy Jackson, American singer-songwriter and dancer
- 1980 — Ben Foster, American actor
- 1944 — Denny Laine, English singer-songwriter and musician (died 2023)
- 1957 — Dan Castellaneta, American actor, voice artist, comedian, singer and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2014 — A mud slide; the 2014 Badulla landslide, in south-central Sri Lanka, kills at least 16 people, and leaves hundreds of people missing.
- 2015 — China announces the end of its one-child policy after 35 years.
- 2012 — Hurricane Sandy hits the east coast of the United States, killing hundreds, while leaving nearly $70 billion in damages and causing major power outages.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1972 — The three surviving perpetrators of the Munich massacre are released from prison in exchange for the hostages of the hijacked Lufthansa Flight 615.
- 1986 — British Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher opens the last stretch of the M25 motorway.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1998 — In South Africa, the Truth and Reconciliation Commission presents its report, which condemns both sides for committing atrocities.
- 2008 — A pair of deadly earthquakes hits Baluchistan, Pakistan, killing 215.

- 2014 — A mud slide; the 2014 Badulla landslide, in south-central Sri Lanka, kills at least 16 people, and leaves hundreds of people missing.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES FRI 30 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 303 of the year, 62 days left in 2026. Today Anniversary of the Declaration of the Slovak Nation (Slovakia); Christian feast day: Ethelnoth (Egelnoth) the Good; Christian feast day: Blessed Benvenuta Bojani; Christian feast day: Blessed Dominic Collins (Catholic, Ireland, Society of Jesus). Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Ashley Barnes, Austrian-English footballer
- 1984 — David Mooney, Irish footballer
- 1973 — Michael Oakes, English footballer and manager
- 1970 — Nia Long, American actress
- 1951 — Harry Hamlin, American actor
- 1961 — Larry Wilmore, American comedian and television host
- 1956 — Juliet Stevenson, English actress
- 1953 — Charles Martin Smith, American actor, director, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1944 — Holocaust: Anne and Margot Frank are deported from Auschwitz to the Bergen-Belsen concentration camp, where they die from disease the following year, shortly before the end of WWII.
- 1947 — The General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT), the foundation of the World Trade Organization (WTO), is founded.
- 1975 — Forty-five people are killed when Inex-Adria Aviopromet Flight 450 crashes into Suchdol, Prague, while on approach to Prague Ruzyně Airport (now Václav Havel Airport Prague) in Czechoslovakia (present-day Czech Republic).

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2013 — Forty-five people are killed and seven injured after a bus catches fire in Mahabubnagar district, Andhra Pradesh (present-day Telangana), India.
- 1944 — Holocaust: Anne and Margot Frank are deported from Auschwitz to the Bergen-Belsen concentration camp, where they die from disease the following year, shortly before the end of WWII.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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